
AUDIOBOOK STUDY COMPANION

The Magic of Believing

The Science of Setting Your Subconscious Mind to Work

Claude M. Bristol

Read by Mike Chamberlain

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THE FRAMEWORK

Three Movements Through the Mind

Claude Bristol spent a lifetime as a reporter and banker chasing one question: what invisible force lets a few people overcome every obstacle and reach the heights they aim for? His answer was a single word — belief — and the nine chapters of this book walk a natural arc from discovery, to method, to proof. We group them into three movements. The first shows that belief is a real power seated in the subconscious. The second hands you the working tools to feed and direct it. The third sends belief outward and watches it turn into results. Read straight through, the arc becomes a working system: decide what you believe, program it in, and project it into the world.

MOVEMENT I

THE FORCE

Belief is a real power — the discovery, the evidence, and where it lives.

01 How I Came to Tap the Power of Belief · 02 Mind Stuff Experiments · 03 What the Subconscious Is

MOVEMENT II

THE METHOD

The tools that feed and direct the subconscious mind.

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MOVEMENT III

THE PROOF

Belief reaching outward — and turning into results.

07 How to Project Your Thoughts · 08 Women and the Science of Belief · 09 Belief Makes Things Happen

MOVEMENT I

THE FORCE

Belief is a real power — the discovery, the evidence, and where it lives.

01 How I Came to Tap the Power of Belief

02 Mind Stuff Experiments

03 What the Subconscious Is

CHAPTER 01

How I Came to Tap the Power of Belief

The golden thread that runs through everything

“There is genuine magic in believing.”

KEY STORIES & EXAMPLES

- As a penniless casual soldier near Toul, France, in the spring of 1918, Bristol decided one sleepless night on a crowded troop train that he would one day have a fortune — and unexplained orders soon swept him from pushing wheelbarrows to First Army Headquarters and the Stars and Stripes. For years he doodled dollar signs on every paper that crossed his desk.
- Sailing on the Empress of Japan, he hungered for Trappist cheese the steward swore wasn't aboard — then a giant wheel of exactly that cheese appeared, dug out of the emergency store room in the bottom of the hold.
- Boarding a homebound ship, he told himself, "You'll sit at the captain's table" — and was handed Table A, seat five, directly across from the captain, who later admitted, "Something told me to seat you at my table."
- A neighbor's warts vanished after a stranger simply offered to count them — one of many cures Bristol traces, alongside Dr. Frederick Kalz's finding that wart charms work whenever the patient believes in them.

THE CORE LESSON

Across a lifetime of investigating cults, cures, and self-made fortunes, Bristol found a single golden thread running through every teaching that ever worked, and it can be named in one word: belief. Held clearly enough, a belief sets unseen forces in motion.

BRISTOL'S TAKEAWAYS

1. Belief is the motivating force behind achievement — the starting power that turns intention into result.
 2. You need not know how the result will arrive. Bristol never planned the mechanics of his fortune; he simply held the belief and let events unfold.
 3. The same law is at work whether the aim is money, health, or a place at the captain's table. It is indifferent to the object of your desire.
 4. "Believe that you have it, and you have it." A settled inner confidence is what produces outward, material results.
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CHAPTER 02

Mind Stuff Experiments

Thought is a force, and now science can measure it

“All that we are is the result of what we have thought.”

KEY STORIES & EXAMPLES

- Glance around any furnished room, Bristol says, and you are looking not at objects but at thoughts made visible — the glass, the draperies, the sewing machine, the skyscraper all began in someone's mind.
- At Duke University, Dr. J.B. Rhine ran millions of dice throws with a mechanical thrower since 1934; subjects concentrating on certain numbers influenced the fall of the dice, refuting odds of millions to one and proving mind can move matter.
- In 1944, after twelve years of experiments, Dr. H.S. Burr at Yale concluded that a faint electrical field of its own making surrounds every living thing — the first scientific footing for the ancient idea of an aura.
- A gambler Bristol knew would never approach a punch board unless, in his words, he was "in the frame of mind that I'm going to win" — at the slightest doubt, he walked away.

THE CORE LESSON

Thought is a genuine, creative, magnetic force, akin to electricity, and modern science is beginning to prove it. Thought creates after its kind: what you steadily dwell on, you tend to attract.

BRISTOL'S TAKEAWAYS

1. Thought is the original source of all wealth, invention, and achievement — every material thing had its counterpart first in a mind.
2. Rhine's dice work and Yale's aura research move mind-over-matter from theory toward demonstrated fact.
3. Thoughts operate like a radio station: their creative power is proportional to their constancy, intensity, and emotional charge.
4. Fear-thoughts are just as magnetic as hopeful ones. "The thing which I greatly feared is come upon me" — so guard what you dwell on.

CHAPTER 03

What the Subconscious Is

You have two minds — learn to direct the deeper one

“The judgment of the subconscious mind is virtually infallible.”

KEY STORIES & EXAMPLES

- Wrestle with a problem until you're exhausted, then let it go, and it seems to sink downward inside you — and by morning the solution has often appeared, fully formed, before your mind's eye.
- Novelist Louis Bromfield told how he trained his subconscious to work while he slept, waking to find problems of plot and character solved that had troubled him for weeks.
- It was an old book pressed on Bristol at law school — Thompson J. Hudson's *Law of Psychic Phenomena* — that first opened his eyes to the subconscious, though he admits he understood it only superficially at first.
- The French psychologist Gustave Geley held that the best results in life come from close harmony and cooperation between the conscious and subconscious minds.

THE CORE LESSON

You have two minds: the conscious mind of reason, logic, and the five senses, and the subconscious mind of instinct, memory, and ceaseless work. Success comes from getting them to cooperate and directing the deeper one on purpose.

BRISTOL'S TAKEAWAYS

1. The conscious mind reasons and observes; the subconscious accepts what it is given and works day and night to carry it out.
2. Hand the subconscious a problem before sleep and it will often deliver the answer by morning — its judgment is nearly infallible.
3. Repetition is the doorway to the subconscious, which is why this whole science leans so heavily on repeated impression.
4. Real power comes from harmony between the two minds — a clear conscious intent, faithfully handed down to the subconscious.

MOVEMENT II

THE METHOD

The tools that feed and direct the subconscious mind.

04 Suggestion Is Power

05 The Art of Mental Pictures

06 The Mirror Technique for Releasing the Subconscious

CHAPTER 04

Suggestion Is Power

Repetition turns a statement into a conviction

“Just believe you can do it, and you can.”

KEY STORIES & EXAMPLES

- Every mystical tradition, Bristol notes, runs on the same engine — repetition. Theos Bernard, in *Penthouse of the Gods*, describes Tibetan monks in Lhasa repeating a single prayer 108,000 times in one day, from daybreak on.
- Alexander the Great cut the Gordian knot on an oracle's word that whoever loosed it would rule Asia; Napoleon carried a star-sapphire given him as a child with the prophecy it would make him Emperor. Supernormal belief made them supermen.
- An old Swiss gardener insisted on talking to every tree and shrub as he planted it — "telling them they must live and bloom" — a habit he'd learned as a boy in the old country.
- Advertising, Bristol says, is simply repeated suggestion: hear a claim often enough and you first believe it, then you buy — the vitamin craze and the fall of Popeye's spinach both trace to it.

THE CORE LESSON

Suggestion — repeated words and affirmations, whether your own (autosuggestion) or from outside (heterosuggestion) — is how belief is planted in the subconscious. Enough repetition turns a mere statement into a deep conviction, and conviction into reality.

BRISTOL'S TAKEAWAYS

1. Repetition is the mechanism behind every ritual and creed: the same words, said again and again, become belief.
 2. Autosuggestion is talking to yourself on purpose — "I can do that," repeated until you actually believe it.
 3. Whatever you repeat, the subconscious accepts as true and sets to work making real — for good, as with Alexander, or for ill, as with fear and superstition.
 4. You are already being advertised to all day; the remedy is to become your own steady advertiser of the outcome you want.
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CHAPTER 05

The Art of Mental Pictures

Hold the picture of what you want on the screen of your mind

“Just picture him as one of those harmless old bears — and the mental hazard is gone.”

KEY STORIES & EXAMPLES

- A young salesman, terrified of a growling millionaire client, was told to picture the man as a toothless dancing bear in a fez — days later he sold him twenty thousand dollars in securities, and he used the same trick, picturing a gruff, white-whiskered old man as Santa Claus, for a five-thousand-dollar order.
- During the Depression, a grocery chain coached each clerk to hold a mental picture of customers buying one featured item per day; the cheese store outsold six months of sales in a single day, and the squash store had to restock twice.
- A printer read Bristol's manuscript, told himself he'd find a parking space right by the office, and did — repeatedly, over years — while more than trebling his business.
- A motherly woman talked her way out of a traffic ticket by insisting the light "just had to be green," because she always neared an intersection repeating, "Green light be on, green light be on."

THE CORE LESSON

Visualization is the core technique: hold a clear, vivid mental picture of what you desire, and reframe what frightens you until it shrinks. Impressed on the screen of the subconscious, that picture pulls its own realization toward you.

BRISTOL'S TAKEAWAYS

1. Reframe fear with imagery — the intimidating figure pictured as a harmless bear or a kindly Santa loses its power over you.
2. Write your dominant desire on cards and place them where you'll see them all day: billfold, mirror, bedside, desk.
3. The last minutes before sleep and the first on waking are the most powerful for impressing the picture on the subconscious.
4. Don't script the "how." Hold the picture, follow the hunches that come, and let the subconscious open the doors.

CHAPTER 06

The Mirror Technique for Releasing the Subconscious

Look into your own eyes and speak your belief aloud

“If you can convince yourself, you can convince the other fellow.”

KEY STORIES & EXAMPLES

- At a dinner party, Bristol watched a badly intoxicated host grip his dresser, stare into the mirror, and repeat, "You're sober, cold sober, this is your party" — and in five minutes the man straightened, cleared, and hosted the evening flawlessly.
- Winston Churchill, according to Drew Pearson, never gave an important speech without first rehearsing it before a mirror; Woodrow Wilson did the same, and Eric Sevareid caught the evangelist Billy Sunday lecturing his own reflection.
- Bristol fitted mirrors inside the back doors of a pie company's delivery trucks; one driver who'd failed for months to sell a restaurant owner decided how many pies to sell her in the mirror first — and sold ten that day, then fifteen daily.
- To save his own firm during the Depression, Bristol posted mirrors by the office doors and wrote slogans on them in soap — "We're going to win," "Nothing is impossible to an indefatigable mind" — the last thing every salesman saw on the way out.

THE CORE LESSON

The mirror technique supercharges the subconscious: stand before a mirror, look into your own eyes, and speak your goal aloud with real conviction. Because you cannot fool your own reflection, the belief you build there flows out to everyone you deal with.

BRISTOL'S TAKEAWAYS

1. Money and results come from mind-stuff plus energized action — cultivate the consciousness of your goal, then work and save toward it.
2. The technique itself is simple: a mirror, your own eyes, and your affirmation spoken aloud with force.
3. It works because sincerity to your own reflection is hard to fake — the same method served Churchill, Wilson, and Billy Sunday.
4. Enthusiasm is contagious; convince yourself in the mirror and you'll convince the customer, the audience, the room.

MOVEMENT III

THE PROOF

Belief reaching outward — and turning into results.

07 How to Project Your Thoughts

08 Women and the Science of Belief

09 Belief Makes Things Happen

CHAPTER 07

How to Project Your Thoughts

What you send out is reflected back to you

“The thing we get back is a reflection of what we project mentally.”

KEY STORIES & EXAMPLES

- Bristol projected genuine gratitude toward a plumber who'd once helped him; the next time he called, a man appeared at his door within five minutes — the boss had pulled him off an all-day job — and the repair was done in half an hour.
- A metropolitan fire chief who "bore a charmed life" said he always threw a white circle around himself entering danger, a trick learned from Indians as a boy; he lived to retire and died in his seventies of natural causes.
- Stoned by a crowd in Tibet, Theos Bernard remembered his training, straightened his shoulders, fixed his eyes ahead, and strode forward — the crowd not only parted but cleared a path for him.
- Babe Ruth called his shots, batting home runs to the exact field he pointed to against the mightiest pitchers — an act of projected certainty that still reads as uncanny.

THE CORE LESSON

You are broadcasting a mental attitude all the time, and what you project comes back to you. Send out confidence, friendliness, and the expectation of success — throw the white circle of belief around yourself — and people and circumstances respond in kind.

BRISTOL'S TAKEAWAYS

1. What you project returns to you: send out friendly, grateful thoughts and watch the clerk, the driver, and the boss respond — the law of reciprocity is dependable.
 2. Carry yourself as one who expects to win — shoulders back, eyes on the goal — and people give way to that settled aura.
 3. You absorb the vibrations of those around you, so choose your associations and be the positive force; one negative person can wreck a home or a team.
 4. Keep starting something new. Ceaseless application keeps the mind alive; the moment you coast, you begin to rust out.
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CHAPTER 08

Women and the Science of Belief

Bristol's case that women can wield this power as fully as men

“When woman awakens, she is going to play a more vital part than ever...”

KEY STORIES & EXAMPLES

- Told as a child by a gypsy woman in Warsaw that she would be famous, Maria Sklodowska held that belief through poverty and obscurity to become Madame Curie, co-discoverer of radium.
- Florence Nightingale knew her calling early and held to it against every obstacle, saving thousands of lives and raising nursing to a respected profession.
- Sarah Bernhardt suffered failure after failure on the early stage, yet a fierce belief in herself carried her to become one of the greatest actresses of all time.
- Grace Moore sang for her supper as a penniless runaway in Greenwich Village cafés and never lost her confidence, going on to win audiences everywhere — while Helena Rubinstein and Hetty Green built fortunes from the same unshakable self-belief.

THE CORE LESSON

Bristol devotes a chapter to women, arguing they can use this science every bit as advantageously as men and are held back only by not yet realizing the power is theirs. His case rests on sweeping claims about women's nature — more adaptable, unstoppable once committed — and on a roll call of women, from Curie to Grace Moore, who made their own breaks through belief.

BRISTOL'S TAKEAWAYS

1. Bristol's claim is specifically about women: the power of belief is theirs in full, and the moment they realize and claim it, nothing stops them.
 2. Neither poverty, obscurity, nor disability stopped the women he cites — Grace Moore sang for her supper in cafés; Mrs. Bondurant, on crutches at seventy, was still opening a new venture.
 3. A belief planted early and held fiercely can shape an entire life, as it did for Curie and Nightingale.
 4. Persistence through repeated failure is belief in action — Bernhardt's long string of early flops preceded her greatness.
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CHAPTER 09

Belief Makes Things Happen

All is within — back belief with a resolute will

“Whatever man can conceive mentally, he can bring into materialization.”

KEY STORIES & EXAMPLES

- In a 1944 experiment in Chicago, a female moth was confined in a room and a male of the same species released four miles away; within hours he was beating his wings against her window — evidence, the editor said, that ideas fly straight to the mind they're meant for.
- The swallows of Capistrano leave each October twenty-third and return each March nineteenth with unfailing punctuality, and tagged salmon return after four years in the Pacific to the exact spot they left — nature threaded through with invisible communication.
- War-blinded veterans at a school in Avon, Connecticut, learned "facial sight," detecting objects in their path through a kind of mental radar that Dr. Jacob Levine admitted he couldn't explain but knew worked.
- A famous lawyer dictated every letter on his feet, vividly picturing the recipient standing before him and telling him mentally that his terms were right and should be accepted — and his letters nearly always achieved their end.

THE CORE LESSON

Belief, backed by a resolute will, makes things happen. All is within: whatever you can conceive and constantly hold in mind, you can bring into being — so use the cards and the mirror faithfully, and the magic follows.

BRISTOL'S TAKEAWAYS

1. Thought transmission runs through all of nature — the moth across four miles, the salmon returning home — a sign that mind reaches beyond the body.
2. All is within: happiness and success are states of mind, independent of position, wealth, or circumstance — Marcus Aurelius' "waveless bay."
3. No one ever defeated a resolute will. Belief must be backed by an unbending will to become truly unstoppable.
4. Whatever you can conceive and hold constantly, you can materialize — so read and re-read, use the cards and the mirror, and hold on.

PART II

The Action Guide

Believe → Program → Project

The whole book reorganized into a practice you can run: decide what you believe, program it into the subconscious, and project it into the world.

PHASE 1

BELIEVE

Decide what you want and that belief is real

Movement I made the case that belief is a genuine force seated in the subconscious. Before any technique can work, you have to give it something definite to work on.

1 Name your one dominant desire

Pick the single thing you want above everything else and state it in one clear sentence. Vague wishing never takes root in the subconscious; a definite, chosen goal does.

2 Decide that belief is an operative force

Treat belief not as wishful thinking but as a real power, the way Rhine's Duke experiments treat mind's influence on matter. Settle the question first, then act as though it works — because it does.

3 Guard the gate against fear-thoughts

Fear is as magnetic as faith. When a "the thing I greatly feared" thought shows up, refuse it deliberately and replace it with the picture of what you actually want.

4 Begin before you can see how

You don't need the roadmap to start. Bristol had no idea how his fortune would arrive; he simply held the belief and let the subconscious find the route. Commit first, and the way appears.

5 Enlist your second mind

Recognize you have a tireless subconscious that works while you sleep. Hand it your desire clearly, as Bromfield handed it his plots, and let it labor on your behalf around the clock.

PHASE 2

PROGRAM

Feed the belief into the subconscious

Movement II gave the working tools — suggestion, mental pictures, and the mirror. This is the daily practice that impresses your goal on the subconscious until it becomes conviction.

1 Write your desire on cards

Put your goal in one or two words on ordinary business cards. Carry one in your wallet and place the others on your mirror, your bedside, and your desk so you meet the picture dozens of times a day.

2 Charge the morning and the night

Concentrate on your picture in the last minutes before sleep and the first minutes on waking. These are the two open doorways to the subconscious — don't waste them.

3 Repeat it until it becomes conviction

Say your affirmation the way the Tibetan monks repeat their chant. Enough repetition turns a statement into belief, and belief into a conviction the subconscious acts on.

4 Rehearse in the mirror

Stand before a mirror, look into your own eyes, and speak your goal aloud with force — the way Churchill rehearsed every important speech. What convinces your reflection will convince the room.

5 Reframe whatever scares you

When a person or task intimidates you, re-picture it — the fearsome executive as a toothless bear, the gruff old man as Santa Claus — and the mental hazard dissolves before you ever walk in.

6 Back the picture with energized action

Mind-stuff plus effort is what actually builds the thing. Hold your goal constantly and then move toward it — work, save, invest, call — as the money-conscious widow did on her way to an empire.

7 Follow the hunches

Keep a pad by the bed. When ideas arrive — see this person, write that letter, make this call — act on them. That is the subconscious opening doors you couldn't have planned.

PHASE 3

PROJECT

Send the belief out into the world

Movement III showed belief reaching outward and returning as results. Now you broadcast the attitude you want reflected back — and back it with a will nothing can bend.

1 Broadcast what you want reflected back

Send out friendly, grateful, confident thoughts and watch people respond in kind — the plumber, the clerk, the boss. What you project mentally returns to you, usually multiplied.

2 Throw the white circle around yourself

Enter every important moment carrying yourself as one who expects to win: shoulders back, eyes on the goal, like the fire chief and Bernard in Tibet. People give way to a settled, unhurried aura.

3 Do something for the other person first

The law of reciprocity is dependable. Take the initiative, give a sincere compliment, make the boss a friend — and the dividends come back around, often when you least expect them.

4 Choose your associations

You absorb the vibrations of those around you. One negative person can wreck a home or a team, so stay close to the positive and be the positive force yourself.

5 Keep starting something new

Begin one new thing a week, as the seventy-year-old did. Ceaseless application keeps the mind alive; the moment you coast, you rust out like a neglected engine.

6 Remember that all is within

Happiness and success are states of mind, independent of circumstance — Marcus Aurelius' waveless bay. Take charge of your thinking and you take charge of your world.

7 Back belief with a resolute will

Read and re-read the ideas, use the cards and the mirror faithfully, and then hold on through the doubt. No one ever defeated a resolute will.

QUICK REFERENCE

Nine Principles — One Per Chapter

Print this page. Keep it where you'll see it.

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- 01** One force runs through everything that works — belief. Held clearly, it sets unseen forces in motion.
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- 02** Everything man-made began as a thought. Thought creates after its kind, so dwell on what you want.
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- 03** You have two minds. Direct the subconscious with a clear conscious intent and it works day and night.
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- 04** Repetition is the engine. Say a thing often and clearly enough and it hardens into conviction.
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- 05** Hold the picture. Put your desire on cards, see it morning and night, and reframe what you fear.
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- 06** Look into your own eyes in the mirror and speak your belief aloud until your reflection believes it.
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- 07** What you project returns to you. Broadcast confidence and goodwill, and carry your own aura.
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- 08** The power belongs to everyone who will use it. No circumstance of birth or station disqualifies you.
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- 09** Whatever you can conceive and constantly hold, backed by a resolute will, you can bring into being.
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“Know thyself. Know your power. Just believe that there is genuine creative magic in believing — and magic there will be.”